
Book Reviews

The European Union, by D. Watts (Edinburgh: Edinburgh University Press, 2008, ISBN9780748632985); xviii+314pp., £19.99 pb.

This volume serves as another addition to the plethora of introductory EU textbooks currently occupying the marketplace. Like most of its competitors, this book offers chapters concerning the historical evolution of the EU, its institutional infrastructure, the nature of EU policy-making and broader political attitudes towards integration processes.

The strongest part of the book is that covering the machinery of governance where students are offered a succinct overview of the key governing institutions and their respective roles. Later chapters also provide useful coverage of decision-making and legislative processes and there is also discussion of a range of individual policy areas. A glossary of terms at the end of each chapter should provide a useful introductory key to the uninitiated and there is some reference to further reading at the end of the book. The latter is, however, relatively brief and its utility is compromised by the author's reference to earlier editions of standard texts which have subsequently been published in revised editions (for example, George and Bache's volume *Politics in the European Union* is referred to as being 'rather dated' but in its 2001 rather than updated 2006 edition!).

Although the book offers much in the way of useful detail on specific issues it is unfortunate that a source published in 2008 should refer, on its back cover, to '25 member governments' when there have been 27 since January 2007. Although the actual content of the volume does offer coverage of the post-2007 enlargement, this initial blip does engender an air of caution in the reader. There are certainly areas of the substantive content which might have benefited from reappraisal. For example, the early chapters on historical evolution are somewhat uneven; whilst some detail is provided on the origins of the integration project, its progress through the 1960s and key developments from the 1980s onwards, coverage of the 1970s is rather scant. Similarly, whilst some introductory material on integration theory is included, this remains arguably underdeveloped (for example, no effective distinction is made between Hoffman's intergovernmentalism and Moravcsik's liberal variant). The chapters making up section 5 on 'Attitudes' are arguably the weakest in structural terms. Although these seek to examine Member State attitudes towards integration processes, the opening heading 'Eligibility for Membership' suggests a discussion on enlargement. The subsequent analysis does indeed consider national attitudes but framing this within the context of successive waves of membership expansion perhaps limits the scope for cross-comparative study of attitudes. It also leads to the

2004 and 2007 accession states being covered in the briefest of fashions and culminates in a conclusion which is swift and almost cursory in nature.

In short, whilst some parts of this book offer useful overviews of the institutional and policy-related facets of the EU the volume as a whole has arguable limitations as a stand-alone introductory textbook.

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The European Union and Culture: Between Economic Regulation and European Cultural Policy, by A. Littoz-Monnet (Manchester: Manchester University Press, 2007, ISBN9780719074356); 176pp., £55.00 hb.

Does culture serve Europe, or does Europe serve culture? Defining Europeanness has become something of a cottage industry among cultural theorists and political scientists alike, all busy locating qualities of self-awareness inherent in a particular quality of European unity. However, Europeanness understood as a conglomeration of European cultural outputs also exists as a policy area subject to a surprisingly early degree of intervention by EU institutions which were keen to apply economic principles to cultural matters by making use of judicial and regulatory powers. Annabelle Littoz-Monnet's recent text has an original perspective on a neglected policy area, and she gets to the point swiftly: European culture may be an ethos, but it is also a distinct policy space attractive enough to invite Member States protective of national competence and EU institutions desirous of wider competences to compete. The corpus of Europe's unique offerings produced over the centuries can therefore be reduced to turf battles between national governments and EU institutions in which cultural policies were gradually but effectively communitarized.

Littoz-Monnet explores a number of such tensions in her fresh if occasionally wordy text. In examining the continuous contortions that arose between EU institutions and national governments for control over cultural policy, she treats with some sophistication the dichotomous definitions of culture as either unique to a national style or a utilitarian output subject to market mechanisms. From there, she is able to isolate two central actors. On the one hand, the *dirigiste* camp largely underwritten by French cultural sensibilities arguing that literature, films, art, music as well as anything that counts as 'heritage' are specific to their own culture and national context and clearly exempt from market mechanisms. On the other, a coalition of actors regarding culture as a far wider series of outputs whose activity is fundamentally mercantile and therefore subject to the same liberalizing, barrier-reducing forces that the community established from the beginning. As Littoz-Monnet points out, contrary to popular belief, *dirigiste* attempts to impose French cultural contours have largely ceded to the mercantile perspective, itself underwritten by the regulatory impulses of the Commission and early rulings of the European Court of Justice.

The text's dynamic multi-level model and actor-based methodology are decently established early on, though more could have been done to explain how these models assisted in clarifying the sequencing of ideas, interests and the continuous interaction of policy formulation. Better are the three neatly drawn and defended case studies.

These are genuinely interesting in detailing how an ideational attachment to one of these two camps enabled policies on television broadcasting, book market pricing regulation and copyright policies to become emphatically communitarized to a surprising degree, more so than national styles and policy-making would have originally suggested. The conceptual arithmetic of understanding the constituent parts of cultural policy is a necessary exercise if we are to appreciate the sum of Europe itself. Littoz-Monnet's research suggests that what Europe does at the EU level is in large part a feature of what Europeanness now is, or is meant to be.

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EU Security Governance, by E. Kirchner and J. Sperling (Manchester: Manchester University Press, 2007, ISBN 9780719074691); xxiv+280pp., £15.99 pb.

EU Security Governance provides a broad and compelling study of the role of the European Union, as a central provider of European security, in view of the increasing intersection of military and non-military elements of the security agenda. The book links the challenges of governing European security to the changing nature of the state, examines the evolutionary expansion of the security agenda and the growing obsolescence of traditional forms and concepts of security co-operation, and offers an alternative conceptual approach to the traditional understanding of security. In doing so, it aims to investigate whether the EU has been effective in realizing its stated security objectives and those of its Member States.

Kirchner and Sperling explore the tension between the imperative of solidarity and sovereignty prerogatives facing EU Member States when tackling internal and external security challenges, in order to assess the constraints and promise of the EU as a security actor and the EU's role in governing European security. Concentrating on the four security governance tasks of prevention (in the EU neighbourhood), assurance (peacebuilding in south-eastern Europe), protection (challenges of internal security) and compliance (use of military force), the authors reveal the limitations and opportunities of transferring sovereign prerogatives from the Member States to the EU. In each of the four policy domains, the authors examine whether the emergence of the EU as a security actor complements the role of states as a security provider, progressively displaces national governments in critical security areas or simply remains a forum for intergovernmental bargaining. They also shed light on the seeming divergence between American and European approaches to security.

The book argues that the EU occupies a central role in the governance of European security; the EU has emerged as a significant and quasi-autonomous security actor. The empirical analysis of the four security policy domains demonstrates that the EU possesses a greater degree of freedom from its constituent states in the creation and execution of policies of prevention and assurance. However, the security policies of compellence and protection remain hostage to the vitality of the sovereignty principle, the constant privileging of the state when invoking the subsidiarity principle and the dominance of intergovernmental bargaining.

The book constitutes the first in-depth and systematic study of the plethora of economic, political and military instruments the EU employs in its different security functions. It also represents an important step towards redressing conceptual gaps in the study of security governance, particularly as it pertains to the European Union. This volume is well suited to advanced students and academics in the fields of European studies, European integration, European politics, security studies and international relations.

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Sleeping Giant: Awakening the Transatlantic Services Economy, edited by D.S. Hamilton and J.P. Quinlan (Washington, DC: Center for Transatlantic Relations, 2007, ISBN9780978882150); v+208pp., £14.99 pb.

This volume addresses the elephant in the room when it comes to trade: eliminating barriers to trade in services. Liberalizing services is both tempting and dangerous – enormous theoretical gains are balanced by considerable practical and political risks. In this debate, editors Daniel Hamilton and Joseph Quinlan argue for the removal of regulations which they see as hampering the potential of the transatlantic services economy.

The book begins with an overview of the European and American service sectors, followed by a series of case studies on financial services, health services and telecommunications. Lawrence White provides a wealth of data on remaining restrictions to trade in US services, as well as an analysis of the positions of US policy-makers. Arjan Lejour provides a coherent overview of European efforts to complete the internal market in services, although pays little attention to controversy surrounding the services directive.

This highlights the book's main problem: discussions of the political and regulatory consequences of liberalizing services are largely absent. Chapter 4 is the best example of this. The authors make several controversial assumptions about the 'pluralization' of health services, such as the desirability and ease of increasing private provision alongside publicly funded care. Addressing trade in pharmaceuticals, they endorse the American model, citing high turnover of drugs as evidence of its superiority. However, recent research shows that the US model drives up costs for consumers and businesses, and is ultimately unsustainable. Other chapters are more reflective. Randal Quarles creates a case for reforming financial services by questioning the goal of a single transatlantic market, contrasting the costs and benefits of harmonization and mutual recognition. Andrea Renda explains how American and European telecoms regulation has diverged, suggesting areas where co-operation could prove fruitful. Bernard Hoekman stresses the need for the global trade regime to adapt in order for services negotiations to progress beyond the limitations of the GATS. He points out that the success of liberalization is reliant on the capacity of countries to enact good regulation.

Overall, this is a useful collection of data for those interested in the growth of trade in services, but it is not the whole picture. It demonstrates the potential for

integrating services, but does not address the effects of liberalization on existing policies, choosing to see regulation as largely obstructive. In the current economic climate, some of these arguments look dated. Public spending and stimulus, not deregulation, dominate the agenda. Many policy-makers recognise the potential benefits of liberalizing trade in services: that is one reason why they are already following that path. But getting the policy right is important. Entering these debates with our eyes shut to the risks of liberalization as well as the benefits will not increase the likelihood that the sleeping giant turns out to be gentle.

HOLLY JARMAN

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European Elections and Domestic Politics: Lessons from the Past and Scenarios for the Future, edited by W. van der Brug and C. van der Eijk (Notre Dame: University of Notre Dame Press, 2007, ISBN9780268043698); xiv+320pp., €45.00 pb.

This book focuses on European elections from 1979 to 1999, with a few reflections on the 2004 European elections which occurred as it was being written. Overall, the chapters confirm the idea of European elections being second-order national elections and, as such, both unlikely to change in future, and contingent upon and likely to reflect domestic political contests and concerns. This is qualified by the view that media coverage may increase if European integration becomes more contested and controversial and if countervailing pressure for media coverage does not arise from competing international issues (such as regional war). For bigger governing parties, it is shown that there is a detrimental impact on their support the more European integration is contested. While electoral volatility, when measured against national (general) elections, is lower than sometimes supposed, averaging under 5 per cent, its impact on government stability varies across the Member States. The editors argue that the greater political contestation is over European integration, the greater its salience is and this greater increasing politicization and salience will generate increasing electoral volatility at the level of the individual voter, if much less so at the level of parties' electoral strength (p. 245). At the same time, the likelihood of contagion across borders has to be recognized.

In general, the chapters are lucid, well-drafted and provide quantitative data in support of the hypotheses relating to: (i) media attention to European integration and European elections; (ii) positioning of parties on European integration; (iii) turnout; (iv) party choice and outcomes. The wealth of data on party manifestos is drawn on and a concise but deep picture of the issues and use made of supranational party manifestos is provided. Somewhat more controversial perhaps are the assumptions regarding the undermining effect on domestic politics of defects and weaknesses in electoral connection (with voters) at the European level. The authors argue convincingly that 'Euro election results cannot be interpreted as indicative of voters' support for existing forms and directions in European integration [. . .]'; they imply that the second-order character of euro elections is the consequence of existing constitutional arrangements in the EU which insulate the most important institutions and policy processes in the EU from popular influence' (p. 246). They argue that in 1999 the preconditions for effective

electoral representation of a single electorate do exist but their sustainability cannot be taken for granted. Television coverage is shown to have differential impact (p. 140), depending on how controversial EU issues are rather than on the amount of time given to covering them. 'EU actors' seem to fail to inspire the public.

Overall, this welcome addition provides quantitative data (using the 1999 European Election Survey study data) supporting many long-held truisms, beliefs, qualitative observations and traditional explanations of the factors affecting voter mobilization, starting from tests of the esteem rating (the less esteem, the lower turnout) to evaluation of media coverage. This is the book's greatest strength.

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Plumbers and Visionaries: Securities Settlement and Europe's Financial Market, by P. Norman (Chichester: John Wiley, 2007, ISBN978047074255); xii+352pp., £45.00 hb.

Peter Norman's book covers the seemingly abstruse subject of European securities settlement. But if there is one thing the current economic crisis has taught us, it is the importance of what are considered obscure technical areas of international financial markets. That being said, one of the few things in financial markets which still seems to be operating effectively is the securities settlement process. Nevertheless, there are insights into the operation of securities markets leading up to the crash, not least the €450 trillion value of securities transaction in 2006!

These insights aside, this book makes two very valuable contributions to the literature. First, it provides a very detailed and lucid account of the development of the European securities settlement from its origins in the 1960s. Second, it provides a comprehensive case study of the development of a functional area of European co-operation. What is particularly interesting about this is the interaction between this process and European integration. To begin with this process is driven by financial globalization, in particular the development of the Eurobond markets, and technology in the form of computers. The organizations involved, in addition to the security settlement organizations such as Euroclear, are not those of the EU but the G30, central banks and national regulators. With the development of the euro and more recently the Lisbon Agenda the EU has become more influential in this area.

The book is organized in 18 chapters in four parts. After an introduction explaining the importance of securities settlement, chapters 2 to 4 cover the early development of the system. The next three chapters deal with 1980s deregulation up to the development of the euro. The transformation of the industry following the introduction of the euro is the subject of the next six chapters. Finally, the EU's response as it attempts to develop a European financial integration under the Lamfalussy proposals is analysed. So overall, this book provides a detailed case study of the development of European integration in practice and is essential reading for those concerned with the operation of European financial markets.

BRIAN ARDY
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Euroclash: The EU, European Identity and the Future of Europe, by N. Fligstein (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2008, ISBN9780199542567); vi+279pp., £25.00 hb.

In his latest work Neil Fligstein analyses the impact the European Union's market integration project has had on economic activity on the one hand and on social interactions on the other. His declared goal is to document the extent of amalgamation that has taken place within economy, society and politics in Europe and to understand how people from different societies have interacted in order to create the foundations of a European society. He furthermore wants to draw attention to the emergence of possible conflicts between citizens who have benefited from the economic and social integration project and those who have suffered from increased market competition. According to the author, contemporary political debates on the future of Europe are conditioned by this clash between winners and losers.

The different chapters of Fligstein's book follow a clear pattern. The first four chapters are predominantly descriptive, laying the base for the analysis in the following four chapters. In chapter 1 the general outline and background of the book is explained. Chapter 2 reviews the economic and political formation of the EU and explains the effects those developments had on the working of different industries. Chapter 3 demonstrates how the largest European corporations have reorganized themselves on a European basis. Chapter 4 analyses the process of European market integration in three distinct fields: defence, telecommunications and football industries. In chapter 5 Fligstein then turns to the question of who in society actually feels European and why this group is still a minority. He subsequently explores in chapter 6 different fields, in which social and cultural integration is currently taking place, comparing them to other areas where national culture dominates. In chapter 7 the author questions the structure of European politics before concluding that 'Europe as a social and cultural project is clearly a social class project. The class aspects of European economic and social integration explain some of the anti-EU national politics that have emerged' (p. 251). In his opinion the future of the EU integration project depends on the successful integration of all citizens, winners and losers, generating some form of European identity from systematic social, political, economic and cultural interaction.

Neil Fligstein's work is an important contribution from a sociologist's point of view to the rich literature on the EU integration project. Despite the author's warning in the preface of having used a lot of jargon and a 'confusing kaleidoscope of data gathered from many sources over a long period of time' (p. viii), his book is written in a very accessible style, illustrating well this new interpretation of the drive to European integration. The only irritating element might be the instances of disjointed writing present in some chapters.

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Multilevel Regulation and the EU: The Interplay between Global, European and National Normative Processes, edited by A. Follesdal, R.A. Wessel and J. Wouters (Leiden: Martinus Nijhoff Publishers, 2008, ISBN9789004164383); xvii+420pp., €150.00 hb.

From the political economy perspective, this book is a neat compilation of legal case studies in the subfield of governance and policy-making. Concentrating on the phenomenon of multi-level regulation and the interaction between competing levels of governance, the authors give a lengthy account of international regulatory fragmentation. 'Mapping the unmappable' through a variety of interesting case studies, the book aims to provide the reader with a response from the legal community to fervently debated topics such as globalization and interdependence.

The analysis can be divided into two distinct parts. With regard to the first section of the book, namely the interplay between global, European and national regulation, there tends to be disappointment with the overall originality of the theoretical contributions and conclusions. Upon deeper scrutiny, one is left with the distinct impression that this legal response is a little too late. Yes, there are multiple levels where global governance takes place. Yes, there are multiple actors and interests competing for power within these forums. Yes, the role of ideas and epistemic communities is important in shaping the norms behind multi-level regulation, and these normative hierarchies change according to individual case studies. Finally, yes, there is no clear causation in the interaction between these various levels of policy-making, while the strict dividing lines between international, national and European law have indeed been blurred. All this has been said before, with little additional insight into the discussion of the fragmentation of international law.

In the changing landscape that accompanies the effervescent debate on the role of power in contemporary global politics, it should also be forgiven that the authors were unable to foresee the future and modify their case studies with evolving events. So unfortunately, the authors could not cover the financial crises and their implications for the debate on multi-level regulation. The complexity and fragmentation of multilevel governance is now even more pronounced. The role of the state in international regulation, even more confused.

The second focus of the book, namely the normative process, provides a far more interesting contribution to the debate on the political, ethical and legal consequences of multi-level governance and regulatory activities. It is in these sections and case studies where the focal point turns to the normative aspects of regulation, that the significance of the policy-making dilemmas becomes evident for human rights, judicial control and the rule of law. Here, the debate between efficiency and accountability in international regulation is well highlighted. The case studies and the subjects broached underlie the important and difficult tensions between democracy, accountability, legitimacy and social justice, on the one hand, and credibility, on the other. It is up to the reader to form his or her own opinion whether multi-level regulation can or should be made more normatively legitimate, but it is certainly worth asking the question.

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A Union of Diversity: Language, Identity and Polity-Building in Europe, by P.A. Kraus (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2008, ISBN9780521676724 pb., 9780521859394 hb.); xiv+230 pp., £17.99 pb., £54.00 hb.

Against the backdrop of the deepening and widening, the present complex polity of the European Union deserves much academic attention. Even though there are plenty of works on 'unity and diversity' of the Union, Peter A. Kraus' book provides a valuable addition to the existing literature. The theoretical and interdisciplinary analysis of European integration, furnished with sufficient empirical evidence, helps the reader, not only to get a comprehensive picture about the language politics of EU but the contemporary institutional development in the international realm as well. The book is trying to unravel the puzzled nexus of the linguistic and cultural differences and the democratic integration within the Union.

The clearcut 'No' from two founding members, France and the Netherlands, has implicitly shown that a common European identity is not possible from above. The book has seven impressively lucid chapters. Kraus examines the possibility of the European countries becoming a constitutional community and the hurdles to their dream of becoming a transnational democratic institution. He discusses the institutional reforms and language policies made by the EU, but argues that the reforms and policies become an intergovernmental balancing act.

The central theme of the book is that the linguistic and cultural diversity have a significant impact on European political integration and the construction of transnational democratic institutions. According to the author, the major impediment to forming a pan-European public is the multiplicity of language. He highlights the policies adopted by the Union to circumvent the identity crisis and the Union's inability to address the language question. Kraus also examines the significance of the principle of subsidiarity and the challenges of constitutional policies.

In his ambitious project the author has managed to combine primary and secondary sources in a refreshingly clear style. Kraus offers a fascinating analysis and provides a pragmatic solution to the complex policy-level problems of the EU. The title of the book itself works like an abstract to the entire volume. However the volume is not beyond criticism. The policy-level options provided by the author are not easy because language is bonded intricately with national cultures. Again, the balancing policies will only lead to policies from above. The absence of a shared memory and a collective identity will become obstacles at the implementation level. A democratic deficit cannot be tackled easily without a collective identity.

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The European Union and the Asia-Pacific: Media, Public and Elite Perceptions of the EU, edited by N. Chaban and M. Holland (London and New York: Routledge/UACES, 2008, ISBN9780415421386); xii+239pp., £80.00 hb.

The book is the outcome of an EU-financed transnational research project run by the University of Canterbury, New Zealand. It claims to offer a systematic analysis of the 2004 EU images in the public discourses of Australia, New Zealand, South Korea and Thailand, focusing on the media, the public and national elites. Its overall findings can be caricatured: Asia-Pacific perceives the EU egocentrically and sees it as an economic giant with little international political clout.

Regarding the media, 3,811 items from 20 leading regional newspapers and 186 from eight national prime-time television newscasts were targeted. Despite differences, the four countries presented a coherent vision of the EU. The media saw the Member States as the predominant political actors, thus the EU as an entity was obscured, but EU images featured more frequently in economic matters. The EU commanded the least attention in the social sphere; hence it was denied a 'human face'.

The public was randomly sampled in national structured telephone surveys (400 adults, in each country *irrespective of population size!*). Chapter 3, the tersest and intellectually most satisfying, finds that 'the structure and attitudes/perceptions of the EU of Australians and New Zealanders are remarkably similar, but the pathways to them are substantially different. Information access through the media and family/friends has a strong and unconditional relationship on attitudes to the EU in Australia; those of NZ are more complicated: national self-interest concerns loom larger, information effects are strongest for those having the least connectivity to Europe.

National elite views were ascertained by interviews with a random selection of 90 key informants from business, politics and the media but only with academic elites *including in Korea*. This clearly contradicts the claim of 'meticulous and consistent sampling procedures' (p. 7). Chapter 7 finds some commonality of views, with the EU being regarded as an important domestic partner after the US and Asia, and as a player of some sort on the international scene, but outside economics, it is viewed as a superpower-in-waiting.

Overall the book is somewhat disappointing; except for the excellent chapters by Jones and Bruter, it is purely descriptive data-findings. On top of that, 2004 was not a 'routine year' to be assessing attitudes to the EU: with the largest enlargement; European Parliament elections; the appointment of a new Commission; the conclusion of the Constitutional Convention and so on. It is suggested that 'these highly noteworthy events of global significance would raise the EU media visibility in the Asia-Pacific', but would one assess one's own image by going to the pub in fancy clothes? Moreover, the book is poorly edited: half of chapter 3 offers background information on EU-Asia which even if needed, should be in the introduction; chapter 6 not only has no place in a comparative study, but also quotes over-generously particularly from the former PM John Howard and Minister of Foreign Affairs Alexander Downer, and basically employs data from a previous study.

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European Society, by W. Outhwaite (Cambridge: Polity Press, 2008, ISBN9780745613321); viii+206pp., £15.99 pb.

William Outhwaite's *European Society* offers an analysis of what binds Europeans together and what sets Europe apart from other regions. Outhwaite claims that we can speak of a European culture, be not a homogeneous one; Europe's nation-states have many things in common, but there are also differences between them. Placed in a broader, global context we can detect several distinctive 'European' features, some of which have developed (and are still being transformed) exactly because of Europe's interaction with other regions of the world. These features started to emerge during the Renaissance, the Reformation and the beginnings of the voyages of discovery and conquest.

Outhwaite discusses his claim by focusing on geographical divisions, Europe's economy, the European polity and social differences and identity. The EU's recent eastern enlargement returns as a key theme throughout the book. Europe may have become 'post-western' (p. 25) in an internal sense (for example, following enlargement) and an external sense (for example, due to dealings with areas beyond Europe's own east). According to Outhwaite differences between eastern and western Europe are less prominent than usually asserted and are often levelled out due to the processes of Europeanization and globalization.

Another recurring feature is Outhwaite's emphasis on Europe as consisting of the EU and its Member States and being shaped by interactions between them. Many non-EU countries such as Norway are so closely associated with the EU that they may be included as well. For instance, Outhwaite argues that Europe's supposed democratic deficit is embodied at the European *and* the national level (pp. 92–3), the only future of European democracy being a 'multi-levelled' solution (p. 98).

The introductory chapter and the chapters on the east–west and north–south divisions and the European polity are especially worthwhile, presenting a good overview of ongoing discussions and current thinking as well as providing arguments for Outhwaite's case. The discussions of the European economy and social differences sometimes tend to become slightly more detached overviews of possible approaches to these issues, rather than articulate analyses of ideas linked to the book's central claim. These chapters may therefore be less attractive for those interested in the supposed main focus of this book.

Outhwaite's relatively short book is an interesting and thought-provoking study, but could have been even more so if the author had further reflected on and expanded his arguments for the existence of a European culture and society. Overall, the emphasis sometimes seems to be more on discussing the (presumed) differences between European states than on presenting what it is that Europeans share, except for the possible future of a cosmopolitan, 'Scandinavian' society (for example, pp. 57 and 141). Nevertheless, *European Society* presents an interesting thesis and generally attractive discussion of the subject at hand.

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Just Another Major Crisis? The United States and Europe Since 2000, edited by G. Lundestad (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2008, ISBN9780199552030); xiv+334pp., £35.00 hb.

Edited by Geir Lundestad, *Just Another Major Crisis* is an in-depth and lucid account of US–European relations during the last decade with many references to the period of the cold war and the Clinton administration. It is a collection of papers from a symposium, where experts shared their thoughts on the past, present and future of transatlantic relations. The topics include Nato, security and the war on terror, co-operation on non-European issues, transatlantic cultural interaction, economic co-operation and competition, to name just a few.

The publication generally asks whether the chilly relations between Europe and the US during the Bush administration reflect a deeper structural crisis or a temporary drift from close partnership, which is common in any international relationship. Disputes over the Iraq war, the Kyoto Protocol, the International Criminal Court or the landmine treaty deeply divided the US and the EU and we do not know if these divergences may prevail in the long term. The American–European relationship is presented in a wider historical context contrasting traditional approaches of European multilateralism versus US unilateralism. As a result, the book offers insightful accounts of transatlantic partnership from political, military, economic and cultural perspectives considering the contrary views from the US and the EU.

I found the chapters by Charles A. Kupchan and David P. Calleo particularly interesting. Kupchan first evaluates the key periods in the US–European relationship to draw trajectories of repair, stable equilibrium and further erosion in the future of transatlantic relations, assuming that the US–European turmoil is set to last. Calleo intelligently explains the intricacy of economic interdependence between the two, discussing them in the light of the emerging Asian superpowers. In addition, the editor Geir Lundestad, who is a director of the Norwegian Nobel Institute, aptly summarises the 13 contributions and adds his rather carefully optimistic view on the US–EU relationship. To find out more about the role of realism and idealism in transatlantic relations from Lundestad, an interview with him is available on Youtube.

The book is likely to attract international relations specialists as well as those simply interested in transatlantic partnership. The authors failed to reach a consensus on the response to the question: just another Atlantic crisis? They all, however, are in agreement that economic partnership is in good shape due to the equality in economic strength on both sides of the Atlantic. The authors assure us that despite many differences the transatlantic marriage of convenience is going to last and divorce between the two is unlikely.

ANNA SYDORAK-TOMCZYK
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EU Criminal Law and Justice, by M. Fletcher and R. Lööf, with B. Gilmore (Cheltenham: Edward Elgar, 2008, ISBN9781845426972); xic+235pp., £65.00 hb.

This work considers the legal and institutional frameworks underpinning EU criminal law and justice. As its authors successfully demonstrate, this field suffers not only from a contradictory set of guiding principles, but the absence of a broader theoretical framework. *EU Criminal Law and Justice* develops this critique, but does not attempt to provide an encyclopaedic guide to relevant legislation.

Fletcher, Lööf and Gilmore do not purport to explain the missing theoretical justification for EU action. Instead, their critique in chapter 1 focuses on demonstrating difficulties with various justifications that have been presented thus far. In so doing, they demonstrate flaws in the application of spillover theory to this field. Chapter 2 outlines key issues that arise from the EU institutions' involvement, but focuses on the institutions specific to the 3rd pillar. The third chapter on police co-operation explains extra-EU co-operation as a consequence of the limits to Union co-operation. It considers the legal framework of police co-operation but does not consider practical operational co-operation in detail. Chapter 4 on judicial co-operation emphasizes mutual recognition, and in this context the European Arrest Warrant and its human rights impact. The *ne bis in idem* principle also receives considerable attention as an example of the judicial approach to mutual recognition. Chapter 5 is concerned primarily with EU external relations law. Whilst the influence of international measures on EU action is briefly examined, considerable space is devoted to transatlantic co-operation. Chapter 6 considers the substantive criminal law of the Union. This examines the competence debates, the interrelationship between the harmonization of criminal law and mutual recognition, and leads to a critique of the moral posturing evident in European criminal policy. The last two sections provide an introduction to criminal law issues that is suitable for readers with a background in EU law. The introduction to the book likewise offers an introduction for criminal lawyers wishing to understand the European dimension.

The authors' critical examination of the relevant legal frameworks highlights the main themes of academic writing on the subject, contributes a timely commentary to those issues and reviews a wide range of sources. Fletcher, Lööf and Gilmore are wise to emphasize their critique, rather than the minutiae of the system under scrutiny. Notwithstanding the ring-fenced, and more detailed, discussion on the Lisbon Treaty, many existing instruments and institutions are presently under review. Whilst the complexity of its subject precludes casual browsing, careful consideration of this work comes with rich rewards. As a normative critique of EU criminal law, this book fills a significant gap in the English-language literature and must be read by all who seek to understand why profound reflection is needed on the theoretical underpinnings of EU criminal justice.

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The Protection of Minorities in Wider Europe, edited by M. Weller, D. Blacklock and K. Nobbs (Basingstoke: Palgrave Macmillan, 2008, ISBN9781403995117); x+296pp., £60.00 hb.

While the EU minority protection literature is booming, a solid up-to-date work of synthesis has been missing until now. Weller *et al.* fill this gap, producing a truly impressive volume boasting the right balance between insightful generality and meticulous detail. The book is the fruit of the work of an impressive cohort of authors, including the leading experts – Will Kymlicka, Wojciech Sadurski, Gabriel von Toggenburg and Marc Weller, to mention just a few. The editors overwhelmingly succeed in putting together a volume containing mutually complementary chapters while avoiding repetition. The main strength of the book is in its focus, which is not the European Union alone. It thus also covers what the Commission labels on its external relations website ‘the other Europe’. Besides the EU, the book also analyses the work done in the field of minority protection by other international organizations active in the region: the Council of Europe, the OSCE and, especially, its High Commissioner on National Minorities. The complementary nature of the actions of all these organizations is the common thread running through the book. Both the strengths and the weaknesses of such connections are clearly demonstrated. Among the hot issues of minority protection law and policy, the book masterfully treats all the usual suspects. How do we define minorities? What are the standards of protection? Should the EU be entitled to become a serious actor in this domain? Should the gap in EU’s external and internal standards for minority protection stay? What are such standards after all? Where will the influence of the new Member States after enlargement lead us? The discussion provided is always inspiring and balanced.

The main possible criticism of the book under review relates to the fact that it did not provide those sceptical about the idea of minority protection with an opportunity to make their voices heard. The volume’s initial assumptions are thus not discussed at all – and there is no place for dissent. The target audience is absolutely clear: the book is written for those viewing the idea of minority protection sympathetically. Yet, allowing a couple of sceptics in could have done it good.

All in all, if you count yourself among the supporters of the minority protection idea, this book is indispensable next to region- or topic-specific studies, such as the recent *European Integration and its Effects on Minority Protection in South Eastern Europe* (E. Lantschner *et al.*, eds., 2008) and *Minority Protection in Supranational Context* (G.N. von Toggenburg, ed., 2004); it is a must-read for those following minority protection developments in Europe.

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The European Union and Crisis Management: Policy and Legal Aspects, edited by S. Blockmans (The Hague: T.M.C. Asser Press, 2008, ISBN9789067042864); xxvii+429pp.

This book by Steven Blockmans stands out both by the scope of the study and the timing of its publication. The scope encompasses both legal and political aspects of EU crisis management, the two becoming interestingly intertwined when it comes to analyses of treaty provisions and ECJ cases. The timing of the book, marked notably by the Lisbon Treaty and the SALW/ECOWAS case, offers substantial and up-to-date food for thought addressed here by several different contributors.

It gives a thorough state-of-the-art review of the academic debate on the three issues that have constituted the bulk of the literature on EU foreign policy in recent years, namely the development of EU crisis management capabilities, the coherence of its institutional setting and the emergence of a shared EU strategic culture. Among the very good contributions on these subjects, those of Jean-Yves Haine and Sven Biscop, although quite different in style and orientation, offer two particularly precious insights and stimulating reflections on the gaps and the dynamic interactions between the EU's strategic orientations, its capabilities and its record so far.

As Steven Blockmans states in his introduction, EU crisis management policy has passed the age of innocence and now faces a 'maturity test' as attention must now be centred on the effectiveness and impact of EU crisis management policies. The book's most innovative sections in this respect are those on EU relations with other international institutions like Nato, the UN, the African Union and the OSCE, and the regional case studies on the Balkans, Africa and Asia. These contributions address the need for detailed analyses of the implementation of EU crisis management policies, and its complex interactions with the other international actors involved. To what extent has the EU been able to deliver so far in specific crises around the world, compared to the needs of the situation?

The book in this respect points out the need to complement studies centred on EU institutions, capacities and operations with case studies comparing the EU contribution to crisis management to that of other actors (including its own Member States), and balancing its effective input with critical insights into its potentially conflict-fuelling actions or inactions in the fields of development, trade and economic policies. It does not assess the extent to which the EU is but one option among many for national foreign policies in specific crisis contexts. Thorough analyses on these subjects would however go beyond the reach of a book whose main achievement is to provide a most useful overview of the most recent developments in the legal and institutional aspects of EU foreign policy.

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The European Council, by J. Werts (London: John Harper Publishing, 2008, ISBN9780955620218); xix + 271pp., £20.00 pb.

The European Council is the EU institution that generally attracts the most media attention and yet we still know relatively little about what really goes on behind its firmly closed doors. Jan Werts is exceptionally well-qualified to try to remedy this situation, having observed and reported on almost all the European Council meetings during the past 35 years. His long career as a European correspondent based in Brussels ensures that the book is rich in fascinating anecdotes and illuminating insights. But it is not just an interesting and informative personal memoir. The author is also a scholar who has meticulously researched the Commission's rich archives of official documentation and conducted interviews with 22 high-level actors who have been directly involved in the meetings. As a result it is a significant addition to the academic literature and will be of use on courses at all levels.

The book is very clearly structured into five substantial chapters, each in turn subdivided into a large number of sub-sections and boxes of explanatory or illustrative text. In some ways this rather fragments the prose and makes the development of the argument less fluent. On the other hand, it makes it very easy to dip into the book and pick out those points which seem particularly interesting or useful.

The five chapters cover: the origins of the European Council, which Werts argues lie in the very earliest days of European integration rather than the mid-1970s as is usually suggested; the functioning of the European Council in the institutional framework of the Union, where he is particularly interested in exploring the impact of its growing importance on the classic institutional balance; its most important successes and failures, looking at the landmark European Councils, from Milan 1985 to Lisbon 2007; the role of the European Council in a Union of 27+ Member States which focuses on assessing the changes contained in the Lisbon Treaty, specifically the implications of the upgrading of the European Council into an official institution of the Union and the introduction of a full-time Presidency; and finally a concluding chapter putting forward a number of policy proposals for the future.

The central argument of the book is what he calls 'the unstoppable march' of the European Council towards its position today as the Union's 'supreme political organ' (p. xvii and p. 188). The answer to the question he set at the beginning as to who leads the European Union is clearly in his mind: the European Council and the Lisbon Treaty would strengthen its position further. This study is therefore a timely contribution both to our knowledge and understanding of the European Council and the dynamics of the evolving institutional balance in the Union.

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International Actors, Democratization and the Rule of Law. Anchoring Democracy?, by A. Magen and L. Morlino (Abingdon: Routledge, 2009, ISBN9780415492959); xvi+292pp., £66.50 hb.

Throughout the last decade a growing body of literature has been evolving around the issue of democracy promotion. Nevertheless, as the editors of this volume contend, the dynamics of international influence on domestic democratic development remain poorly understood. By focusing on the EU's influence on domestic democratic reform processes, more precisely the promotion of the rule of law in four neighbouring transitional countries, Magen and Morlino seek to provide a well-conceptualized and empirically well-grounded study that contributes various new lessons for both academics and practitioners. Above all, democratization theory and democracy promotion in practice should benefit from a better understanding of hybrid regimes, especially illiberal or minimal democracies and ambiguous regimes, which have become more widespread recently and which are deemed 'morally and practically pernicious' (p. 5). Not devoid of a normative stance, the book investigates how these regimes may be transformed into substantive or higher-quality democracies. As 'democratic rule of law' is singled out as the key indicator for democratic quality, international legal studies are another audience for this volume. In the field of European studies, it offers a comparative study on the EU–democratization nexus that may reveal a broader canvas of EU engagement strategies by combining enlargement and non-enlargement cases.

The editors start by discussing these various contributions in more detail (chapter 1), before presenting the analytical framework for the following analysis (chapter 2). While the first chapter poses an overwhelming range of questions about the theoretical and empirical state of knowledge concerning the extent, nature and limitations of international influence on domestic democratic (rule of law) development, the second chapter sharpens the analytical perspective by arriving at a model that conceptualizes concrete 'EU cycles and layers of international democratic anchoring' (EUCLIDA). On this basis, the next chapter discusses EU rule of law promotion as the independent variable of this model, followed by country case studies that represent four different categories of EU engagement: prospective members (Romania, chapter 4), negotiating candidates (Turkey, chapter 5), potential candidates (Serbia, chapter 6) and European neighbourhood countries (Ukraine, chapter 7). In contrast to many edited volumes, these case studies keep the promise of a rigorous comparative analysis. Each case is analysed with regard to the same dimensions and processes of rule of law promotion, thus providing a convincing basis for a truly comparative discussion about the multiple external and domestic factors influencing rule of law reforms (chapter 8). While highly revealing indeed, this reading leaves room for future studies in two respects in particular: the conclusion that (unlike conditionality) socialization mechanisms are difficult to trace empirically; and the assumption (based on a sample of sufficiently successful cases of 'democratic anchoring') that the chances of democracy promotion in authoritarian regimes are very limited.

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The History of the European Union: Origins of a Trans- and Supra-National Polity 1950–72, edited by W. Kaiser, B. Leucht and M. Rasmussen (Abingdon: Routledge, 2009, ISBN 9780415463935); xii + 228 pp., £70.00 hb.

The Young Turks of European integration historiography have wanted to write a book along these lines for more than a decade. The editors argue that a theoretically rigorous history of the development of European institutions will overturn the vague neo-liberal, quasi-realist orthodoxy inspired by Milward's work. The direction chosen here enlists social scientific concepts – primarily networks, socialization and the public sphere – in order to locate the grounds for a reinvigorated 'transnational' history of European institution-building, one not dependent, as such histories once were, on the assumed power of ideas.

If much of this is recognizable as historical institutionalism, it is the emphasis on the historical which sets the work apart from other examples of the genre. Particularly in the introductory chapters, the history of the European institutions is framed by the comparison between the organizations which foster transnationalism and nationalism, with an intriguing gesture towards the similarities between the post-war motors of European institution-building and the 19th-century nationalist elites. The editors only sketch questions and tools of analysis for this 'trans- and supranational history', though Warleigh-Lack helpfully concludes with an assessment of the interdisciplinary contributions of key chapters. The volume also highlights more in-depth studies already conducted on this basis.

While the ambition of the editors appears bold, the thought-provoking research presented in the volume does not sustain the reader's expectation of an entirely new paradigm for the history of European institutions. Indeed, promising elements of the introductory theorization are overlooked in the remainder of the work: epistemic communities disappear, as does the long-term historical context. Leucht's chapter is particularly helpful for defining the role of 'German *ordo-liberalism*', a point which other contributors extend beyond the making of the ECSC treaty but which is not contextualized historically, at the expense of the promising agenda set out in earlier chapters. The same is true of the prior history of the business networks identified by Ramírez Pérez, of Steinnes' insights into networking among the Socialist parties of the EFTA Member States, and of the reception of the Hague Summit by a wider public sphere in 1969 (Meyer). Valuable chapters follow which deliberately confine themselves to institutional developments within the European Community, on competition policy (Seidel), information policy (Rye), Parliament (Knudsen) and Coreper (Ludlow).

Advanced students with a grounding in European integration historiography will find the agenda and research presented here stimulating. The work is not aimed at novice readers: it does not – in spite of its title – provide an overview of the development of European institutions, instead focusing on specialist institutions and policy areas which will be of more interest to those seeking fresh approaches and material.

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